

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

100 Practice Questions & Answers

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Exam tip: The real exam has 65 questions. You need ~70% (46/65) to pass. Focus on the Shared Responsibility Model, IAM, EC2 pricing, and S3 storage classes.

Cloud Concepts

Q1. What is the AWS definition of cloud computing?

- A. On-demand delivery of IT resources via the internet with pay-as-you-go pricing
- B. Hosting servers in a private data center
- C. Purchasing hardware in advance for future use
- D. Renting fixed-capacity servers for a monthly fee

Answer: A

Explanation: AWS defines cloud computing as on-demand delivery of IT resources over the internet with pay-as-you-go pricing — you use what you need without large upfront investments.

Cloud Concepts

Q2. Which of the following is a key benefit of moving to the AWS Cloud?

- A. Eliminating all operational overhead
- B. Trading capital expense for variable expense
- C. Unlimited free storage
- D. Fixed monthly costs regardless of usage

Answer: B

Explanation: One of AWS's core value propositions is replacing large upfront capital expenditure (CapEx) with variable operational expenditure (OpEx), so you only pay for what you consume.

Cloud Concepts

Q3. What does 'elasticity' mean in cloud computing?

- A. The ability to resist hardware failures
- B. The ability to scale resources up or down automatically based on demand
- C. A pricing model for reserved capacity
- D. A type of database replication

Answer: B

Explanation: Elasticity is the ability to automatically acquire resources as you need them and release them when you don't — matching capacity to actual demand in real time.

Cloud Concepts

Q4. Which cloud deployment model runs infrastructure exclusively on-premises using cloud technologies?

- A. Public cloud
- B. Hybrid cloud
- C. Private cloud
- D. Community cloud

Answer: C

Explanation: A private cloud runs entirely within an organization's own data center. A hybrid cloud combines on-premises with public cloud.

Cloud Concepts

Q5. What is the AWS global infrastructure component that consists of one or more discrete data centers?

- A. Availability Zone
- B. Region
- C. Edge Location
- D. Local Zone

Answer: A

Explanation: An Availability Zone (AZ) is one or more discrete data centers with redundant power, networking, and connectivity within an AWS Region.

Cloud Concepts

Q6. How many Availability Zones make up a Region (minimum)?

- A. 1
- B. 2
- C. 3
- D. 6

Answer: C

Explanation: Every AWS Region has a minimum of three Availability Zones to ensure high availability and fault tolerance.

Cloud Concepts

Q7. Which AWS service delivers content to users with low latency using a global network of edge locations?

- A. AWS Direct Connect
- B. Amazon CloudFront
- C. Amazon Route 53
- D. AWS Global Accelerator

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon CloudFront is AWS's Content Delivery Network (CDN) that caches content at over 400 edge locations worldwide, reducing latency for end users.

Cloud Concepts

Q8. A company wants to move its servers to AWS but keep some workloads on-premises. This is called a:

- A. Public cloud
- B. Private cloud
- C. Hybrid cloud
- D. Multi-cloud

Answer: C

Explanation: A hybrid cloud architecture combines on-premises infrastructure with public cloud resources, allowing workloads to run in both environments.

Cloud Concepts

Q9. Which of the following best describes the 'pay-as-you-go' pricing model?

- A. Pay one flat monthly fee
- B. Pay only for the resources you actually consume
- C. Pay upfront for a year of service
- D. Pay based on the number of users

Answer: B

Explanation: Pay-as-you-go means you're charged only for the exact amount of compute, storage, or other services you actually use, with no long-term commitments required.

Cloud Concepts

Q10. What is an AWS Region?

- A. A single data center
- B. A geographic area containing multiple Availability Zones
- C. A content delivery network node
- D. A virtual private network

Answer: B

Explanation: An AWS Region is a physical location around the world that contains multiple, isolated Availability Zones. Each Region is fully independent.

Cloud Concepts

Q11. What is 'high availability' in cloud computing?

- A. Running all workloads in a single Availability Zone
- B. Designing systems that remain operational despite component failures
- C. Using the cheapest instance types
- D. Provisioning more capacity than needed at all times

Answer: B

Explanation: High availability means designing systems to minimize downtime. In AWS, this typically involves deploying across multiple Availability Zones so failures in one AZ don't take down the entire system.

Cloud Concepts

Q12. What is a benefit of AWS's global infrastructure for a company with international users?

- A. Increased compliance complexity
- B. The ability to deploy applications closer to end users, reducing latency
- C. Higher costs due to data transfer fees
- D. Limited database options

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS has Regions and edge locations worldwide, allowing companies to deploy applications geographically close to their users, reducing network latency and improving user experience.

Cloud Concepts

Q13. Which of the following is NOT one of the six pillars of the AWS Well-Architected Framework?

- A. Security
- B. Cost Optimization
- C. Scalability
- D. Reliability

Answer: C

Explanation: The six pillars are: Operational Excellence, Security, Reliability, Performance Efficiency, Cost Optimization, and Sustainability. 'Scalability' is not one of the named pillars.

Cloud Concepts

Q14. What is the concept of 'fault tolerance' in cloud architecture?

- A. The ability to handle increased load
- B. A system's ability to continue operating properly when one or more components fail
- C. Minimizing costs during peak load
- D. Automatically backing up data

Answer: B

Explanation: Fault tolerance means a system continues operating without interruption even when some of its components fail. This is achieved through redundancy and automatic failover mechanisms.

Cloud Concepts

Q15. A startup wants to test a new application without large upfront costs. Which cloud benefit best describes this?

- A. High availability
- B. Agility and low upfront investment
- C. Dedicated hardware
- D. Compliance automation

Answer: B

Explanation: Agility is a key cloud benefit — the ability to quickly experiment, spin up resources, and scale only if the application succeeds, without large upfront capital investments.

Security

Q16. What is the AWS Shared Responsibility Model?

- A. AWS is responsible for everything
- B. Customers are responsible for everything

- C. AWS manages security OF the cloud; customers manage security IN the cloud
- D. Customers manage hardware; AWS manages software

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS secures the underlying infrastructure (hardware, software, networking, facilities), while customers secure their data, applications, and configurations running on AWS.

Security

Q17. Under the Shared Responsibility Model, which of the following is the customer's responsibility?

- A. Physical security of data centers
- B. Patching the hypervisor
- C. Encrypting customer data
- D. Maintaining network infrastructure

Answer: C

Explanation: Encrypting customer data is always the customer's responsibility. AWS provides the tools (KMS, SSE), but the customer decides whether to use them.

Security

Q18. Which AWS service provides centralized user and permission management?

- A. AWS Shield
- B. Amazon Cognito
- C. AWS IAM
- D. AWS WAF

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Identity and Access Management (IAM) lets you manage access to AWS services and resources securely by creating users, groups, roles, and policies.

Security

Q19. What is the recommended best practice for the AWS root account?

- A. Use it for daily administrative tasks
- B. Enable MFA and avoid using it for everyday tasks
- C. Share credentials with the entire team
- D. Disable it after initial setup

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS strongly recommends enabling MFA on the root account and using it only for tasks that specifically require root access — create IAM users for daily work.

Security

Q20. Which service protects AWS accounts against DDoS attacks?

- A. AWS WAF

- B. AWS Shield
- C. Amazon GuardDuty
- D. AWS Inspector

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Shield is a managed DDoS protection service. Shield Standard is free for all customers; Shield Advanced provides enhanced protections and 24/7 DDoS Response Team access.

Security

Q21. What AWS service acts as a managed firewall to filter web traffic?

- A. AWS Shield
- B. AWS WAF
- C. Amazon VPC
- D. Security Groups

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS WAF (Web Application Firewall) lets you create rules to allow, block, or monitor web requests based on conditions like IP addresses, HTTP headers, or SQL injection patterns.

Security

Q22. Which AWS service continuously monitors for malicious activity and unauthorized behavior?

- A. AWS Config
- B. Amazon Inspector
- C. Amazon GuardDuty
- D. AWS CloudTrail

Answer: C

Explanation: Amazon GuardDuty is a threat detection service that continuously monitors AWS accounts and workloads for malicious activity using machine learning and threat intelligence.

Security

Q23. What is AWS CloudTrail used for?

- A. Monitoring application performance
- B. Recording API calls made in your AWS account
- C. Managing firewall rules
- D. Scanning for vulnerabilities

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS CloudTrail records all API calls made across your AWS account, capturing who did what, when, and from where — essential for auditing, compliance, and security investigations.

Security

Q24. Which AWS service checks EC2 instances for software vulnerabilities?

- A. Amazon GuardDuty
- B. AWS Config
- C. Amazon Inspector
- D. AWS Trusted Advisor

Answer: C

Explanation: Amazon Inspector is an automated vulnerability management service that continuously scans EC2 instances and container images for software vulnerabilities and unintended network exposure.

Security

Q25. What principle should be followed when assigning IAM permissions?

- A. Grant maximum permissions to all users
- B. Grant only the minimum permissions needed (least privilege)
- C. Use one IAM user for all applications
- D. Never use IAM roles

Answer: B

Explanation: The principle of least privilege states that users and applications should be granted only the minimum permissions required to perform their tasks — nothing more.

Security

Q26. What is AWS KMS (Key Management Service)?

- A. A password manager for IAM users
- B. A managed service for creating and controlling encryption keys
- C. A DDoS protection service
- D. A certificate authority

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS KMS is a managed service that makes it easy to create and control encryption keys used to encrypt your data. It integrates with most AWS services.

Security

Q27. What does MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication) add to an AWS account?

- A. Faster login speeds
- B. An additional layer of security requiring a second form of verification
- C. Automatic password rotation
- D. Single Sign-On capabilities

Answer: B

Explanation: MFA adds an extra security layer: even if a password is compromised, an attacker still needs the second factor (e.g., a one-time code) to gain access.

Security

Q28. Which feature of Amazon S3 prevents accidental deletion of objects?

- A. S3 Versioning
- B. S3 Lifecycle Policies
- C. S3 Transfer Acceleration
- D. S3 Event Notifications

Answer: A

Explanation: S3 Versioning maintains multiple variants of an object in the same bucket. Accidentally deleted objects can be recovered by restoring a previous version.

Security

Q29. What is Amazon Macie used for?

- A. Protecting against DDoS attacks
- B. Automatically discovering and protecting sensitive data stored in Amazon S3
- C. Managing IAM permissions
- D. Scanning for network vulnerabilities

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon Macie is a data security service that uses machine learning to automatically discover, classify, and protect sensitive data (like PII and financial data) stored in Amazon S3.

Security

Q30. Which AWS service provides a single dashboard to aggregate and prioritize security findings?

- A. Amazon GuardDuty
- B. AWS Security Hub
- C. Amazon Inspector
- D. AWS Config

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Security Hub provides a comprehensive view of your security state by aggregating findings from GuardDuty, Inspector, Macie, and third-party tools into a single prioritized dashboard.

Security

Q31. Which AWS service is used to manage and rotate secrets like database passwords and API keys?

- A. AWS KMS
- B. AWS IAM
- C. AWS Secrets Manager
- D. AWS Certificate Manager

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Secrets Manager helps protect access to applications and IT resources by enabling you to rotate, manage, and retrieve database credentials, API keys, and other secrets.

Technology

Q32. Which AWS compute service allows you to run code without provisioning or managing servers?

- A. Amazon EC2
- B. Amazon ECS
- C. AWS Lambda
- D. AWS Batch

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Lambda is a serverless compute service. You upload your code, configure a trigger, and Lambda runs it — billed only per request and execution duration, with no server management.

Technology

Q33. What is Amazon EC2?

- A. A managed database service
- B. A virtual server in the cloud
- C. An object storage service
- D. A content delivery network

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon Elastic Compute Cloud (EC2) provides resizable virtual servers (instances) in the cloud. You choose the OS, CPU, memory, and storage to match your workload requirements.

Technology

Q34. Which storage service is best suited for storing unstructured data like images, videos, and backups?

- A. Amazon EBS
- B. Amazon RDS
- C. Amazon S3
- D. Amazon DynamoDB

Answer: C

Explanation: Amazon S3 (Simple Storage Service) is object storage designed for storing any type of unstructured data at virtually unlimited scale with 11 nines of durability.

Technology

Q35. What is Amazon RDS?

- A. A NoSQL database service
- B. A managed relational database service
- C. An in-memory cache
- D. A data warehousing service

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon RDS (Relational Database Service) is a managed service that sets up, operates, and scales relational databases. It supports MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, SQL Server, and more.

Technology

Q36. Which AWS service is a fully managed NoSQL key-value and document database?

- A. Amazon RDS
- B. Amazon Aurora
- C. Amazon DynamoDB
- D. Amazon Redshift

Answer: C

Explanation: Amazon DynamoDB is a fully managed NoSQL database providing single-digit millisecond performance at any scale, with built-in security, backup, and in-memory caching.

Technology

Q37. What is Amazon VPC?

- A. A virtual private server
- B. An isolated virtual network within AWS
- C. A content delivery service
- D. A monitoring dashboard

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon Virtual Private Cloud (VPC) lets you provision a logically isolated network within AWS where you can launch resources in a virtual network you define.

Technology

Q38. Which EC2 pricing model offers the largest discount for a 1 or 3-year commitment?

- A. On-Demand
- B. Spot Instances
- C. Reserved Instances
- D. Dedicated Hosts

Answer: C

Explanation: Reserved Instances offer up to 72% discount compared to On-Demand pricing in exchange for committing to a specific instance type for 1 or 3 years.

Technology

Q39. What are EC2 Spot Instances?

- A. Instances reserved for a fixed monthly fee
- B. Instances using unused EC2 capacity at up to 90% discount
- C. Instances dedicated to a single customer
- D. Instances with guaranteed uptime SLAs

Answer: B

Explanation: Spot Instances use spare EC2 capacity at steep discounts (up to 90% off On-Demand). They can be interrupted with 2-minute notice — ideal for fault-tolerant workloads.

Technology

Q40. Which AWS service automatically distributes incoming traffic across multiple targets?

- A. Amazon Route 53
- B. AWS Auto Scaling
- C. Elastic Load Balancing
- D. Amazon CloudFront

Answer: C

Explanation: Elastic Load Balancing (ELB) automatically distributes incoming traffic across multiple targets (EC2 instances, containers, IP addresses) in one or more Availability Zones.

Technology

Q41. What is Amazon S3 Standard-IA storage class best suited for?

- A. Frequently accessed data
- B. Infrequently accessed data that requires rapid retrieval
- C. Archival data with retrieval times of hours
- D. Auto-tiering based on usage patterns

Answer: B

Explanation: S3 Standard-IA (Infrequent Access) is designed for data accessed less frequently but that requires rapid access when needed. It costs less than S3 Standard but charges a per-GB retrieval fee.

Technology

Q42. Which service enables you to run containerized applications without managing servers?

- A. AWS Lambda
- B. Amazon EC2
- C. AWS Fargate
- D. Amazon EMR

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Fargate is a serverless compute engine for containers. It works with Amazon ECS and EKS, eliminating the need to provision and manage EC2 instances for your containers.

Technology

Q43. What is Amazon Route 53?

- A. A firewall service
- B. A scalable DNS and domain registration service
- C. A load balancer
- D. A CDN service

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon Route 53 is a highly available, scalable DNS service. It translates domain names into IP addresses and supports health checks and various traffic routing policies.

Technology

Q44. Which AWS service provides a petabyte-scale data warehousing solution?

- A. Amazon RDS
- B. Amazon DynamoDB
- C. Amazon Redshift
- D. Amazon Aurora

Answer: C

Explanation: Amazon Redshift is a fully managed data warehouse optimized for OLAP queries across petabytes of structured data, commonly used for business intelligence and analytics.

Technology

Q45. What is AWS Elastic Beanstalk?

- A. A database migration service
- B. A PaaS for deploying web applications without managing infrastructure
- C. A serverless function service
- D. A container registry

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Elastic Beanstalk is a Platform as a Service (PaaS) that automatically handles deployment, capacity provisioning, load balancing, and health monitoring — you just upload your code.

Technology

Q46. Which service is used to migrate large amounts of data to AWS using a physical device?

- A. AWS DataSync
- B. AWS Snowball
- C. AWS Transfer Family
- D. AWS Direct Connect

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Snowball is a petabyte-scale data transport solution using secure physical appliances to transfer large datasets into or out of AWS, bypassing internet limitations.

Technology

Q47. What is Amazon CloudWatch used for?

- A. Managing IAM users
- B. Monitoring resources and applications, setting alarms
- C. Storing log archives long-term
- D. Scanning for security vulnerabilities

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon CloudWatch monitors AWS resources and applications in real time. You can collect metrics, create dashboards, set alarms, and automatically react to changes in your AWS environment.

Technology

Q48. Which AWS service is a fully managed message queuing service?

- A. Amazon SNS
- B. Amazon SQS
- C. Amazon MQ
- D. AWS EventBridge

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon SQS (Simple Queue Service) is a fully managed message queue that enables you to decouple and scale microservices, distributed systems, and serverless applications.

Technology

Q49. What is Amazon SNS?

- A. A queue-based messaging service
- B. A pub/sub notification service that sends messages to multiple subscribers
- C. A NoSQL database
- D. A DNS service

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon SNS (Simple Notification Service) is a fully managed pub/sub messaging service that sends notifications to HTTP endpoints, email, SMS, and Lambda.

Technology

Q50. Which service allows you to define and provision AWS infrastructure as code?

- A. AWS Config
- B. AWS CloudFormation
- C. AWS Systems Manager
- D. AWS OpsWorks

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS CloudFormation lets you model and set up AWS resources using JSON or YAML templates, enabling you to provision and manage infrastructure as code (IaC) consistently.

Technology

Q51. What is AWS Auto Scaling?

- A. A tool to manually increase server capacity
- B. A service that automatically adjusts the number of resources based on demand
- C. A reserved instance pricing model
- D. A database replication feature

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Auto Scaling monitors your applications and automatically adjusts capacity to maintain steady, predictable performance at the lowest possible cost, scaling both in and out.

Technology

Q52. What is Amazon EBS (Elastic Block Store)?

- A. Object storage for websites
- B. Persistent block-level storage for EC2 instances
- C. An in-memory caching service
- D. A managed file system

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon EBS provides persistent block-level storage volumes for use with EC2 instances. Unlike instance store, EBS volumes persist independently of the EC2 instance lifecycle.

Technology

Q53. Which service provides a fully managed, scalable file storage compatible with NFS?

- A. Amazon S3
- B. Amazon EBS
- C. Amazon EFS
- D. Amazon FSx

Answer: C

Explanation: Amazon EFS (Elastic File System) provides scalable, elastic file storage that can be mounted by multiple EC2 instances simultaneously using the NFS protocol.

Technology

Q54. What is Amazon Aurora?

- A. A NoSQL database
- B. A MySQL and PostgreSQL-compatible relational database built for the cloud
- C. A data warehousing service
- D. A caching service

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon Aurora is a cloud-native relational database compatible with MySQL and PostgreSQL, delivering up to 5x MySQL performance with automated storage scaling up to 128 TB.

Technology

Q55. Which service provides an in-memory caching layer to improve database performance?

- A. Amazon RDS
- B. Amazon ElastiCache / DynamoDB Accelerator (DAX)
- C. Amazon Redshift
- D. Amazon DocumentDB

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon ElastiCache (Redis/Memcached) and DynamoDB Accelerator (DAX) are in-memory caching services that reduce read latency from milliseconds to microseconds.

Technology

Q56. What is AWS Direct Connect?

- A. A VPN service over the internet
- B. A dedicated private network connection from your data center to AWS
- C. A content delivery network
- D. A firewall service

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Direct Connect establishes a dedicated, private physical connection between your on-premises network and AWS, providing more consistent network performance than internet-based connections.

Technology

Q57. What is an AWS Security Group?

- A. An IAM group with security permissions
- B. A virtual firewall that controls inbound and outbound traffic for EC2 instances
- C. A WAF rule set
- D. A compliance framework

Answer: B

Explanation: Security Groups act as virtual firewalls for EC2 instances. They control inbound and outbound traffic at the instance level using stateful rules — return traffic is automatically allowed.

Technology

Q58. What is the difference between a Security Group and a Network ACL (NACL)?

- A. They are identical
- B. Security Groups are stateful (instance-level); NACLs are stateless (subnet-level)
- C. NACLs apply to instances; Security Groups apply to subnets
- D. Security Groups apply to S3; NACLs apply to EC2

Answer: B

Explanation: Security Groups are stateful and apply to instances (return traffic auto-allowed). Network ACLs are stateless and apply to subnets — you must explicitly allow return traffic in both directions.

Technology

Q59. Which service provides a managed Kubernetes service on AWS?

- A. Amazon ECS
- B. AWS Fargate
- C. Amazon EKS
- D. AWS Lambda

Answer: C

Explanation: Amazon EKS (Elastic Kubernetes Service) is a fully managed Kubernetes service that makes it easy to run Kubernetes on AWS without installing and operating your own control plane.

Technology

Q60. What is AWS Outposts?

- A. An edge location for CloudFront
- B. A service that runs AWS infrastructure and services on-premises
- C. A private networking service
- D. A content caching appliance

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Outposts brings native AWS services, infrastructure, and operating models to virtually any on-premises or edge location, useful for workloads requiring low latency or local data processing.

Technology

Q61. Which S3 feature automatically moves objects to lower-cost storage tiers after a set period?

- A. S3 Versioning
- B. S3 Replication
- C. S3 Lifecycle Policies
- D. S3 Inventory

Answer: C

Explanation: S3 Lifecycle policies automate transitioning objects between storage classes (e.g., Standard to Standard-IA to Glacier) based on age, reducing storage costs over time.

Technology

Q62. What is Amazon CloudFront's primary use case?

- A. Running containerized workloads
- B. Caching and serving content from edge locations globally with low latency
- C. Managing DNS records
- D. Encrypting data at rest

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon CloudFront is a CDN that caches content at edge locations close to end users, reducing latency for website delivery, APIs, video streaming, and other web content globally.

Technology

Q63. What is AWS IAM Role?

- A. A type of IAM user with elevated privileges
- B. An IAM identity with permissions that can be assumed by AWS services, applications, or users
- C. A group of IAM users
- D. A managed policy template

Answer: B

Explanation: An IAM Role is an identity with permissions policies attached. Roles are not tied to a specific user — they can be assumed by EC2 instances, Lambda functions, or users from another account.

Technology

Q64. What is Amazon SageMaker primarily used for?

- A. Managing relational databases
- B. Building, training, and deploying machine learning models
- C. Running containerized workloads
- D. Providing managed Kubernetes

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon SageMaker is a fully managed service that provides every developer and data scientist with tools to build, train, and deploy machine learning models quickly at scale.

Technology

Q65. Which AWS service is designed for big data processing using Apache Spark and Hadoop?

- A. Amazon Redshift
- B. Amazon EMR
- C. Amazon Kinesis
- D. AWS Glue

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon EMR (Elastic MapReduce) is a managed cluster platform that simplifies running big data frameworks like Apache Spark, Hadoop, and Hive on AWS to process vast amounts of data.

Technology

Q66. What does Amazon Kinesis do?

- A. Manages Kubernetes clusters
- B. Processes real-time streaming data at scale
- C. Provides object storage
- D. Manages DNS queries

Answer: B

Explanation: Amazon Kinesis makes it easy to collect, process, and analyze real-time streaming data (like video, logs, and IoT telemetry) so you can get timely insights and react quickly.

Technology

Q67. Which AWS service helps migrate databases to AWS with minimal downtime?

- A. AWS Snowball
- B. AWS Database Migration Service (DMS)
- C. AWS DataSync

D. AWS Transfer Family

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS DMS migrates databases to AWS quickly and securely. The source database remains fully operational during migration, minimizing downtime. Supports homogeneous and heterogeneous migrations.

Technology

Q68. What is the purpose of Amazon Route 53 health checks?

- A. Monitoring database query performance
- B. Detecting unhealthy endpoints and routing traffic away from them
- C. Scanning for security vulnerabilities
- D. Managing SSL certificates

Answer: B

Explanation: Route 53 health checks monitor the health of your endpoints and can automatically route traffic away from unhealthy resources to healthy ones, enabling high availability DNS failover.

Technology

Q69. Which feature allows S3 to host a static website accessible via a public URL?

- A. S3 Versioning
- B. S3 Static Website Hosting
- C. S3 Cross-Region Replication
- D. S3 Intelligent-Tiering

Answer: B

Explanation: S3 Static Website Hosting allows you to host a static website directly from an S3 bucket. You enable it, specify index/error documents, and objects become accessible via a public URL.

Technology

Q70. What is AWS Step Functions?

- A. A serverless database service
- B. A visual workflow service for coordinating distributed applications and microservices
- C. A network monitoring tool
- D. A cost optimization service

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Step Functions is a serverless orchestration service that lets you coordinate multiple AWS services into serverless workflows using visual state machines.

Technology

Q71. Which networking component allows private subnets to initiate outbound internet connections?

- A. Internet Gateway
- B. Security Group

- C. NAT Gateway
- D. Route Table

Answer: C

Explanation: A NAT Gateway allows instances in private subnets to initiate outbound internet connections (e.g., to download updates) while preventing the internet from initiating inbound connections.

Technology

Q72. What is AWS CodePipeline?

- A. A code editor in the cloud
- B. A fully managed continuous delivery service for automating release pipelines
- C. A version control system
- D. A code review tool

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS CodePipeline is a fully managed continuous delivery service that automates build, test, and deploy phases of your release process every time there is a code change.

Billing & Pricing

Q73. What tool helps estimate AWS service costs before deploying resources?

- A. AWS Cost Explorer
- B. AWS Pricing Calculator
- C. AWS Budgets
- D. AWS Trusted Advisor

Answer: B

Explanation: The AWS Pricing Calculator lets you explore AWS services and estimate the cost of your use cases before committing to any resources.

Billing & Pricing

Q74. Which AWS tool provides real-time visibility into spending and usage patterns?

- A. AWS Pricing Calculator
- B. AWS Trusted Advisor
- C. AWS Cost Explorer
- D. AWS Budgets

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Cost Explorer provides interactive graphs and reports to visualize, understand, and manage your AWS costs and usage over time, with forecasting up to 12 months.

Billing & Pricing

Q75. What is an AWS Budget?

- A. A cap that automatically shuts off services
- B. A tool to set custom cost or usage thresholds and receive alerts

- C. A type of savings plan
- D. A reserved instance purchase

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Budgets lets you set custom cost and usage thresholds and receive alerts when you exceed or are forecasted to exceed them — helpful for tracking spending against targets.

Billing & Pricing

Q76. Which support plan is the minimum required to have access to a Technical Account Manager (TAM)?

- A. Basic
- B. Developer
- C. Business
- D. Enterprise

Answer: D

Explanation: A Technical Account Manager (TAM) is available only with the AWS Enterprise Support plan (and Enterprise On-Ramp). TAMs provide proactive guidance as a dedicated point of contact.

Billing & Pricing

Q77. What is the AWS Free Tier?

- A. A permanent free plan for all AWS services
- B. A set of offers allowing customers to try certain services for free within specified limits
- C. Unlimited free usage for non-profits
- D. A 30-day free trial for all services

Answer: B

Explanation: The AWS Free Tier includes: Always Free (never expires), 12-Month Free (free for 12 months after account creation), and Short-Term Trials. Limits apply to each type.

Billing & Pricing

Q78. Which pricing model allows companies to commit to a consistent amount of usage for discounts?

- A. On-Demand Instances
- B. Spot Instances
- C. AWS Savings Plans
- D. Dedicated Hosts

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Savings Plans offer up to 72% savings compared to On-Demand in exchange for a consistent usage commitment (measured in \$/hour) for 1 or 3 years, with flexibility across services.

Billing & Pricing

Q79. What is the Consolidated Billing feature in AWS Organizations?

- A. A way to split billing across departments
- B. A feature that combines charges from multiple AWS accounts into a single invoice
- C. A tool to compare AWS vs on-premises costs
- D. A detailed report for a single account

Answer: B

Explanation: Consolidated Billing in AWS Organizations combines usage across all member accounts into a single bill and enables volume discounts — combined usage qualifies for tiered pricing.

Billing & Pricing

Q80. An EC2 instance was left running for an entire month. Which pricing model incurs costs for all that time?

- A. Spot Instance
- B. Reserved Instance
- C. On-Demand Instance
- D. Savings Plan

Answer: C

Explanation: On-Demand pricing charges by the hour (or second for Linux) for as long as the instance runs. A running instance for a full month incurs the full On-Demand cost.

Billing & Pricing

Q81. Which support plan provides access to AWS Trusted Advisor's full set of checks?

- A. Basic
- B. Developer
- C. Business
- D. None of the above

Answer: C

Explanation: Business Support (and above) unlocks all Trusted Advisor checks. Basic and Developer plans only provide access to the core seven checks.

Billing & Pricing

Q82. What does 'Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)' help companies evaluate?

- A. The cost of a single AWS service
- B. The full cost comparison between on-premises infrastructure and cloud
- C. The monthly AWS bill
- D. The cost to train cloud engineers

Answer: B

Explanation: TCO analysis compares the total costs of running workloads on-premises vs. in the cloud, including hardware, software, maintenance, energy, facilities, and labor costs.

Billing & Pricing

Q83. Which service helps identify underutilized resources to reduce costs?

- A. AWS CloudTrail
- B. AWS Trusted Advisor
- C. Amazon Inspector
- D. Amazon Macie

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Trusted Advisor's Cost Optimization category identifies idle resources and rightsizing recommendations to help reduce unnecessary spend.

Billing & Pricing

Q84. What is the benefit of Reserved Instances compared to On-Demand?

- A. Higher performance
- B. Up to 72% cost savings for predictable, steady-state workloads
- C. Ability to run on dedicated hardware
- D. No upfront commitment required

Answer: B

Explanation: Reserved Instances offer significant discounts (up to 72%) compared to On-Demand for workloads with predictable usage patterns, in exchange for a 1 or 3-year term commitment.

Billing & Pricing

Q85. Which AWS offering provides a free, always-on set of services with no expiration?

- A. 12-Month Free Tier
- B. Always Free offers
- C. Short-term trials
- D. AWS Educate

Answer: B

Explanation: The Always Free tier includes certain services that remain free regardless of how long you've had your AWS account — for example, 1 million AWS Lambda requests per month.

Billing & Pricing

Q86. How does AWS charge for data transfer?

- A. Always free in all directions
- B. Inbound data transfer to AWS is free; outbound to the internet incurs charges
- C. All data transfer is charged uniformly
- D. Data transfer between services is always charged

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS does not charge for inbound data transfer (uploading to AWS). Outbound data transfer to the internet incurs charges. Transfer between services in the same region is typically free.

Support & Governance

Q87. Which AWS service provides a personalized view of AWS service health and planned maintenance?

- A. Amazon CloudWatch
- B. AWS Service Health Dashboard
- C. AWS Personal Health Dashboard
- D. AWS Trusted Advisor

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Personal Health Dashboard (AWS Health) provides alerts and remediation guidance when AWS events impact your specific resources, unlike the general Service Health Dashboard.

Support & Governance

Q88. What is AWS Trusted Advisor?

- A. A machine learning service
- B. A tool providing real-time guidance on best practices across cost, security, performance, fault tolerance, and service limits
- C. A database optimization service
- D. A compliance certification service

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Trusted Advisor analyzes your AWS environment and provides real-time recommendations across five categories: cost optimization, security, fault tolerance, performance, and service limits.

Support & Governance

Q89. Which AWS service helps enforce policies across multiple AWS accounts?

- A. AWS IAM
- B. AWS Config
- C. AWS Organizations
- D. AWS Control Tower

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Organizations allows centralized management of multiple AWS accounts, enabling consolidated billing, account grouping, and Service Control Policies (SCPs) for governance.

Support & Governance

Q90. What are AWS Service Control Policies (SCPs)?

- A. IAM policies for individual users
- B. Policies applied at the Organizations level to restrict what member accounts can perform
- C. Firewall rules for VPCs
- D. Billing alerts for accounts

Answer: B

Explanation: SCPs are organization policies used in AWS Organizations to set maximum available permissions for member accounts — they define guardrails but do not grant permissions directly.

Support & Governance

Q91. Which tool helps set up a secure, multi-account AWS environment following best practices?

- A. AWS CloudFormation
- B. AWS Control Tower
- C. AWS Config
- D. AWS Organizations

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Control Tower automates the setup of a multi-account AWS environment (landing zone) with pre-built guardrails aligned to AWS best practices.

Support & Governance

Q92. What is AWS Config used for?

- A. Deploying infrastructure as code
- B. Recording and evaluating AWS resource configurations over time
- C. Managing IAM users and groups
- D. Monitoring application performance

Answer: B

Explanation: AWS Config continuously monitors and records AWS resource configurations, enabling compliance checking, change tracking, and security analysis against desired configurations.

Support & Governance

Q93. Which AWS Support plan offers 24/7 access to Cloud Support Engineers via phone, chat, and email?

- A. Basic
- B. Developer
- C. Business
- D. Enterprise

Answer: C

Explanation: Business Support provides 24/7 access to Cloud Support Engineers via phone, chat, and email with a 1-hour response time for production system-down cases.

Support & Governance

Q94. What is the AWS Well-Architected Framework?

- A. A set of hardware specifications for AWS servers
- B. A framework with best practices for designing secure, high-performing, resilient, and efficient architectures
- C. A pricing model for enterprise customers
- D. A compliance certification program

Answer: B

Explanation: The AWS Well-Architected Framework provides best practices organized into six pillars: Operational Excellence, Security, Reliability, Performance Efficiency, Cost Optimization, and Sustainability.

Support & Governance

Q95. What is the 'Reliability' pillar of the Well-Architected Framework focused on?

- A. Reducing costs
- B. Ensuring workloads perform their intended function correctly and consistently
- C. Protecting data and systems
- D. Using resources efficiently

Answer: B

Explanation: The Reliability pillar focuses on ensuring a workload performs its intended function correctly and consistently, including recovering from failures and dynamically meeting demand.

Support & Governance

Q96. Which AWS service provides a compliance dashboard and enables downloading compliance reports?

- A. AWS Config
- B. AWS Audit Manager
- C. AWS Artifact
- D. AWS Security Hub

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Artifact provides on-demand access to AWS compliance reports (SOC, PCI, ISO) and lets you review, accept, and track agreements relevant to your compliance requirements.

Support & Governance

Q97. What is the purpose of an AWS Landing Zone?

- A. A physical location where AWS hardware is installed
- B. A pre-configured, secure multi-account AWS environment aligned to best practices
- C. A launch template for EC2 instances
- D. A compliance report template

Answer: B

Explanation: An AWS Landing Zone is a pre-configured, secure, multi-account AWS environment that serves as a foundation for companies to begin building on AWS with best practices already applied.

Support & Governance

Q98. What is the AWS Acceptable Use Policy (AUP)?

- A. A pricing model for enterprise customers
- B. A policy governing acceptable uses of AWS services and prohibiting illegal or harmful activities
- C. A compliance framework for healthcare
- D. A service level agreement

Answer: B

Explanation: The AWS Acceptable Use Policy outlines prohibited uses of AWS services, such as illegal content, unauthorized access, and spam. All customers must comply with the AUP.

Support & Governance

Q99. Which AWS service helps calculate estimated savings when migrating from on-premises to AWS?

- A. AWS Pricing Calculator
- B. AWS Migration Hub
- C. AWS Migration Evaluator
- D. AWS Cost Explorer

Answer: C

Explanation: AWS Migration Evaluator (formerly TSO Logic) helps businesses model their existing on-premises infrastructure costs versus projected AWS costs to build a business case for migration.
